Lesson 9

The Colours of Bharat

E7D5R6

Let us Explore

Bharat is a country with many states. Do you know any of these states other than Rajasthan? Write the names of any three of them along with what you know about those states:

_____

_____

_____

_____

Let us read

Madhopur is a small village in Rajasthan. The village is surrounded by the sand dunes of the Thar Desert. The people of Madhopur live in colourful houses, wear bright clothes and celebrate festivals with great joy. The village is known for its beautiful handicrafts including attractive mirror work, colourful pottery and vibrant fabrics.

One day, children gathered under a neem tree for a special class. Their teacher, Mrs. Sharma, travelled across Bharat and had many stories of its diverse culture to share.

“Today, we'll explore Bharat's diversity through festivals, food and traditions”, she began. “What makes our country unique?”

A little girl named Rani raised her hand. “Bharat is special because we celebrate different festivals in different places.”

“Exactly!” Mrs. Sharma smiled. “Festivals like Teej and Gangaur bring communities together with music and dance.” Similarly, in Maharashtra, people celebrate Ganesh Utsav. In Punjab, people celebrate Baisakhi, while in Kerala, Onam is a famous festival. Each student was feeling proud to be a Bhartiya, where they had various festivals to celebrate.

Mahesh said, “Teacher may I tell something?”

Mrs. Sharma said. ,“Yes, Mahesh.”

He said, “People wear different clothes in different parts of the country.”

“Absolutely”, Mrs. Sharma replied. “Let's start with our home, Rajasthan. Here, some people design fabrics with mirror work. People wear colorful clothes. Women wear *lehenga, kurti* and *bandhej dupattas,* while the men wear *dhoti* and *kurta*. These clothes are not just for festivals but for everyday life too!” She continued. Students' eyes sparkled as Mrs. Sharma spoke. They remembered the colourful clothes they had at their home.

Then, Mrs. Sharma asked, “What do you know about the food of Rajasthan?”

Raj shared, “We enjoy *dal-baati-churma* here. It's made with local grains and spices.”

“Yes! And we love *sabji of ker-sangri* as well.”, Mrs. Sharma added.

“But Bharat's food changes regionally. “Kerala loves rice dishes like *appam*, coastal areas use coconut and you must have heard of the famous *sarson ka saag* and *makke ki roti* of Punjab.”

The children were amazed at how food varied across the country. They realized that while Rajasthan's food was spicy, other places had their own delicious dishes too.

Mrs. Sharma then took out a map of Bharat. “Look at this map,” she said. “Bharat is not only diverse in food and clothing but also in languages. India has over 120 languages! Here, we speak Hindi and Rajasthani. In Karnataka, it's Kannada; in Nagaland, communities speak *Ao* or *Angami* and *Nagamese*.”

The children nodded, understanding that Bharat's strength lay in its diversity. Mrs. Sharma smiled and said, “But the best part is that even though we speak different languages, wear different clothes and eat different food, we are all Bharatiya. We celebrate our differences and that's what makes us strong.”

Just then, the school bell rang, signalling the end of the class. But Mrs. Sharma had one last thing to say. “Remember, children, Bharat is a place where every culture, every language and every tradition is like a colour on a beautiful painting. Together, they make Bharat the most colourful country in the world!”

The children clapped and cheered. Sugna stood up and said, “I'm so proud to be from Rajasthan! I'll ask my cousin in Assam about Bihu festival traditions!”

Mrs. Sharma smiled and said, “That's the spirit, Sugna! Let's keep learning about our diverse and colourful Bharat.”

And so, the children of Madhopur learned that Bharat was not just a country - it was a beautiful mix of cultures, traditions and colours, all coming together to create a country like no other.

Let's Learn New Words

Find the meaning of the following words and use them in your own sentences -

Handicrafts (n) :

_____

Vibrant (adj) :

_____

Diverse (adj) :

_____

Explore (v) :

_____

Unique (adj) :

_____

Communities (n) :

_____

Fabrics (n) :

_____

Sparkled (v) :

_____

Coastal (adj) :

_____

Let us do it

(I) Select correct option for the following questions -

1. What was the name of the village Rani lived in?
   (a) Madhopur (b) Jodhpur
   (c) Bikaner (d) Udaipur
2. What festival is celebrated in Maharashtra?
   (a) Bihu (b) Ganesh Utsav
   (c) Baisakhi (d) Onam
3. Which festivals of Rajasthan are known for music and dance?
   (a) Ganesh Chaturthi (b) Raksha Bandhan
   (c) Teej and Gangaur (d) Chhath Puja
4. Where is Onam celebrated?
   (a) In Punjab (b) In Kerala
   (c) In Maharashtra (d) In Nagaland

(II) Match the states with their culture or tradition -

1. Rajasthan	a) Celebrates Onam
2. Kerala	b) Practices Bhangra
3. Punjab	c) Celebrates Gangaur

(IV) Answer the following -

1. What is Madhopur known for?
2. Which traditional food of Rajasthan is mentioned in the lesson ?
3. How many languages are spoken in Bharat?

Chatter Champ

Group Task: Cultural Exchange Fair -

1. Step 1: Each student research on one state.

   (e.g., Kerala, Punjab, Bengal).

2. Step 2: Prepare four sentence in English + home language about:

   - Traditional dress
   - Festival
   - Food

3. Step 3: Role-play as a tourist guide using polite phrases:

   - "May I tell you about Kerala's Onam festival?"
   - "Excuse me, would you like to try virtual makki di roti?"